

KOLKATA | Vested Interest



SHAH RUKH WITH ASHOK TODI

Talk about a far from cosy relationship. Shah Rukh Khan ran into trouble again after his Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) tied-up with hosiery brand Lux Cozi, owned by Ashok Todi, an accused in the Rizwanur Rahman suicide case. The unsavoury tie-up had to be 'put on hold' after anger among Kolkatans about the linkage of their IPL team with a businessman central to one of the city's most controversial criminal cases. Shah Rukh and his company Red Chillies Entertainment have not severed ties with the Todis though. The Rs 150 KKR T-shirt, though is now abandoned but it is believed that Todi will eventually not be. Putting the deal 'on hold' was merely a way of crisis management. Kolkata fans are now on high alert about whether Red Chillies will use the money signed on from Lux Industries to promote Todi's company in other ways. *by Elora Sen*

BANGALORE | Word Ware

Students of the city's famous St. Joseph's College have hit on a way to take Kannada to the hearts of non-Kannadigas. Kannada Infomedia is a newly-launched online class in which basic Kannada is learnt by downloading free audio material. College Principal Ambrose Pinto says, "You can only attract non-Kannadigas to learn this language with love, not by force." Maybe Mumbai's Thackerays can get a few tips from St. Joseph's—even though Marathi is not spoken there.

BOMBS PLANTED IN THE AMBALA MILITARY AREA AND HALWARA AIR FORCE STATION DID NOT EXPLODE.

CHANDIGARH | Terror Echoes

Call it sheer luck or sharp intelligence, but Punjab has been able to ward off terror strikes in the recent past. Its latest catches are Jasbir Singh alias Jassa and Harjan Singh alias DC, two men belonging to the Khalistan Liberation Force, from Nabha. Arrested with an 8-kg crude bomb with detonator, firearms and 40 gelatin sticks, the police said the two planned to target vital installations in the state and were also responsible for planting bombs at key places, including in the Ambala military area, which did not explode. Intelligence agencies clearly have their task cut out to maintain the hard-earned peace in Punjab. *by Arvind Chhabra*

by Stephen David

MARUTI SUZUKI HAS RECALLED ONE LAKH A-STAR CARS OVER A FAULTY GASKET.

DELHI | Stars and Gripes

Maruti Suzuki India is recalling about one lakh units of its A-Star to replace a faulty rubber gasket in cars manufactured before August 2009. At an average cost of Rs 15-20 per gasket, experts estimate that it could mean a hit of Rs 20-odd lakh for the company, which it will share with the supplier. Maruti has already changed the part in about 50,000 units after spotting an anomaly during an internal analysis. In 2005, it recalled 500 units of its Zen to fix a faulty radiator. In 2001, 76,000 Omni units were changed for a defective routing of the fuel hose. In 1997, about 50,000 units of the 800 were recalled to fix a faulty pinion in the steering system. Last month, Honda Sael Cars India started recall of 8,532 units of its sedan City due to a defective power window switch. *by Nandini Vaish*



SATISHKAUSHIK/www.indiatodayimages.com